'Round the Mountainside

Quarterly newsletter for Coolfont Mountainside Association

Fall 2020

Holiday Fire Safety Tips

by Heidi Splane, Firewise Chair

Source: NFPA's Fire Applied Research Division

Don't let a joyous occasion turn into a tragedy. By following a few simple safety tips you can enjoy time with your loved ones and keep yourself and your family safe from fire.

- Stay in the kitchen when you are cooking on the stove so you can keep an eye on the food.
- Stay in the home when cooking your turkey. Check on it frequently.
- Keep children at least three feet away from a hot stove.
- Make sure kids stay away from hot food and liquids. The steam or splash from vegetables, gravy, or coffee could cause serious burns.
- Keep knives out of the reach of children.
- Be sure electric cords from an electric knife, coffee maker, plate warmer, or mixer are not dangling within easy reach of a child.
- Keep matches and utility lighters out of the reach of children.
- Never leave children alone in room with a lit candle.
- Keep the floor clear so you don't trip over kids, toys, pocketbooks, or bags.
- Test your smoke alarms to ensure they are working.

Check out this video:
https://youtu.be/kjUynq0HXdQ
NFPA demonstrates the fire dangers of turkey fryers. NFPA strongly discourages the use of turkey fryers. For information on safe cooking visit www.nfpa.org/Thanksgiving

Thanksgiving Fire Facts

Thanksgiving is the peak day for home cooking fires, followed by Christmas Day, Christmas Eve, and the day before Thanksgiving.

In 2017, US fire departments responded to ≈1,600 home cooking fires on Thanksgiving, the peak day for such fires.

Unattended cooking was by far the leading contributing factor in cooking fires and fire deaths. Cooking equipment was involved in almost half of all reported home fires and home fire injuries, and it is the second leading cause of home fire deaths.

UPCOMING EVENTS

Board of Directors Meeting	November 7, 10:00 am	Teleconference
Board of Directors Meeting	December 12, 10:00 am	Teleconference

Take the TP Test

From The Clever Homeowner
March 16, 2019 (Edited for space)

Every time you flush your toilet, everything that was in the toilet travels straight to your septic tank, including your toilet paper. Once it reaches the septic tank, it eventually begins to fall apart and settle at the bottom with all of the other solids. Over time, that solid "sludge" at the bottom of the tank will build up and begin to fill the septic tank. That's why it's important to **regularly pump your septic tank**. The more use the septic tank gets, the more often you'll have to pump your septic tank.

Not all toilet paper behaves the same way inside the septic tank. Some brands will tend to not fall apart, while other brands design their toilet paper to disintegrate into tiny particles. This makes it much easier for the bacteria inside the tank to dissolve the toilet paper and minimize the amount of solids that remain inside the septic tank.

The Best Septic Tank Safe Toilet Paper

Cascades B340 Standard Bathroom Tissue

Cascades' toilet paper is best choice when it comes to septic tank safe toilet paper. The toilet paper is made out of 100% recycled material, and literally disintegrates back into its original little fibers once it hits the water.

Scott 1000 Sheets Per Roll Toilet Paper

Scotts motto is, "Take comfort in the fact that along with softness and strength, ComfortPlus still breaks up fast and is easy on your pipes." According to their website, "Scott 1000 breaks up four times faster than the average bathroom tissue for fewer clogs. Plus, Scott 1000 is always sewer-safe and septic-safe."

Quilted Northern Ultra Plush Toilet Paper

According to their website, "Every roll of our toilet paper gives you three soft, cushiony and absorbent layers that deliver the ultimate comfort, while still offering a septic-safe solution." They also mention their toilet paper is, "...100% biodegradable. This means that when our toilet paper is discarded, the substances that make up our toilet paper are able to be decomposed."



Test Your TP

If you're still not sure which toilet paper is best for your septic system, you can test it yourself! This is especially useful if you have a specific brand of toilet paper you like. You can compare brands and see how your toilet paper performs in the septic tank.

1. Choose 3-4 brands of toilet paper to test.
2. Place 4-5 squares of each into a large mason jar or other clear container.
3. Fill each jar about ¾ full with water. Replace the lid and shake vigorously for 10 seconds.
4. Have a look! If the toilet paper has fallen apart into tiny pieces, you're in luck – it's a good choice for your septic system.

Please consider using biodegradable cleaning products to help protect your septic system and CMA's sewage system.



CMA entrance Gateway was refurbished with a power wash and new coat of paint. Thank you to DACC for the new color scheme and CMA Site Manager for tackling the project.



Andy & Joan Zuckerman (T-6) welcome dinner guests.

Assessments Due January 1

Assessment invoices will be mailed/emailed in late December. Payments are due January 1, and a late fee will be assessed after January 31.

Please note that late fees have increased to 10% of the outstanding balance. Monthly finance charges also apply to accounts that are past due.

Please note the new assessment amounts for 2021:

Assessment for Houses	$1,570
Assessment for Lots	$900
Pool Fee, Rental Property (due May)	$73

You've Got Mail!



The new mailboxes are installed and operational! Two new 16-box Cluster Box Units (CBUs) were added to accommodate owners requesting new CMA mailboxes. A new concrete pad was poured to install all four CBUs and a new parcel locker provided by Berkeley Springs Post Office (thank you!). The new pad will allow for future expansion of up to four additional CBUs on the back side – in case CMA ever needs to add more. The Free Library box was cleaned, given a fresh coat of stain, and relocated near the new mailboxes. It has loads of books – all free for the taking. Guard posts were cleaned, stained, and moved to help protect our new mail area from wayward vehicles.



Each box is labeled with the box holder's street address – making it easy to locate. Each CBU has an outgoing mail slot – it doesn't matter which one you use, USPS will pick up all the outgoing mail. Packages will be placed in one of the 10 parcel lockers. There are two on each CBU and two larger lockers in the center unit. The post carrier will place a key to the locker in your mailbox. Be sure to check the key tag closely for the correct locker to retrieve your package. Note: It may not be in the same CBU as your mailbox. The wooden CMA box will be rebuilt and installed later this month and will accommodate oversized packages.

A big thank you to the Berkeley Springs Post Office staff – Jerry Yost and our carrier, Tara (pictured left) – for spending a full day at CMA reorganizing mailboxes and locks – and thanks to our resident volunteers who helped with this project. If you would like one of the five remaining mailboxes, please contact Dawne Holz, CMA Treasurer.

CMA Artists

by Rosemary Bigelow, O-4

Berkeley Springs is an historic spa and art-filled town. It is the first certified arts town in WV and regularly listed among the best small art towns in the US. The official arts council for Morgan County, MAC, begun in the late 1970s, has been behind the award winning arts programming in Morgan County and makes its home in the Ice House, a community arts venue in the center of town

This year, the Apple butter Festival, Berkeley Springs Studio Tour, Concerts in the Park, and Art in the Park have been cancelled due to Covid-19. MAC theater offerings are being streamed rather than live. Fortunately, the Ice House Gallery, where you can see the work of many local artists, reopened in June and is popular for visitors.

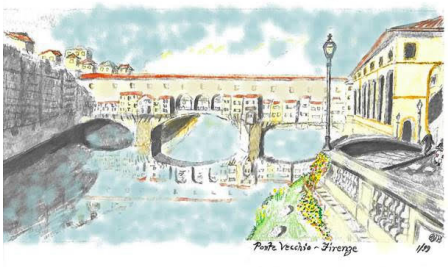
Many of our CMA owners are also artists – some as hobbyists and some as working artists.

Larry Levinson's talent is in the area of acting and writing. He is a good actor and is musical. His talents are coming together in a play he is directing, acting in, and has written a song for. The name of the play is "Holler" and it is set in West Virginia.

Andy Zuckerman, Craig Deane and the late Larry Merola are/were all woodworking artists. Our summer newsletter featured some of Andy's whimsical wood creations. Craig makes beautiful cutting boards, Adirondack chairs, and wine bottle holders. He's also happy to fill custom orders, like the beautiful twig table he made for me. His company is "Craig's Creations" and he shows at the Berkeley Springs Studio Tour and Art in the Park.



Jackson Bain and Richard Kaufman are both watercolor artists. Jackson is in the learning phase of watercolor painting. He has an abiding love for the soft beauty of the medium and painted this charmer of the Arno River in Italy.





Richard Kaufman's watercolor paintings combine Western and East Asian techniques to depict scenes from nature. Richard's company is Magic Mountain Studio. He is a regular participant in and president of the Berkeley Springs Studio Tour and has exhibited at a number of galleries. He has also held several positions with the Sumi-e Society of America. Check out the great YouTube video of Richard talking about his work.



Lisa Johnson also loves to draw and paint. She recently painted the inside of a playhouse for her granddaughters.

Brandon and Kelsey Lindblad, new CMA owners, are both artists. They spent the last 3 years living in an RV and traveling to take photos. Brandon loves photography, especially landscape and wildlife. Their travels include trekking in rainforests of Costa Rica, tiger safaris in India, walking in fields with grizzly bears, and camping in the Arctic Circle of Iceland for arctic foxes. Brandon is hoping to exhibit at the Icehouse and join local art festivals. You can see Brandon's work online and visit his Etsy shop, To Roads Unknown.



Kelsey uses digital media for T-shirt/business designs but her true passion is baking! I know we look forward to the lifting of Covid-19 restrictions so we can return to socializing and sampling the creations of our wonderful CMA cooks.



Jamie Sullivan is also a photographer. He is mainly a nature photographer and considers himself an amateur - though he has sold handful of work over the years. His true passion is underwater photography which he has been doing since 2004. He has been lucky to travel all over the world and see amazing underwater wildlife in the Atlantic, Pacific, and Indian Oceans as well as the Caribbean and Mediterranean Seas. With travel curtailed due to Covid-19, he documented wildlife in the backyard - visible from his new work-from-home office window (with the help of a powerful telephoto lens). Jamie noted, "If it weren't for the pandemic, I never would have seen what I did in my own backyard. The fox is my personal favorite."

Rosemary Bigelow loves textiles, from antique lace to one-of-a-kind custom digital printed creations; her home is filled with bolts and bolts of fabric and her many designs. In 1987 she left a career at IBM to start her own home décor company, My Grandmother's Lace, which makes custom designed home furnishings (pillows, bedding, window treatments, table linens)– all created here in Berkeley Springs. She is a regular exhibitor at the Ice House Gallery a participant and officer of the Berkeley Springs Studio Tour.



Congrats...

to our new Board members, elected at the Annual Meeting in September:
Susan Betts, O-6
Eric Lienhard, G-5
Cindy Van Meter, K-16

Directory Updates

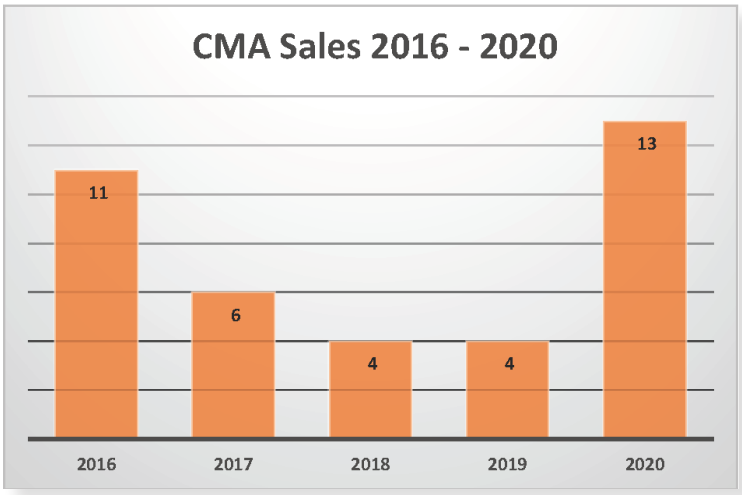


Keep your Membership Directory current with the updates noted below. We will also update the PDF available on the CMA website.

D-2	Michael & Julia Flannery bunkaroono@gmail.com Paul & Susan Ostazeski Part time rental	Bunkaroono (301) 370-0001 (410) 598-0175
K-5	Alexandra Band alexleighband@gmail.com Zvi Band z@rogerten.xyz Part time rental	Bear's Den (202) 507-1335 (301) 219-9183
M-1	Michael Shapiro moderncapital@gmail.com Elissa Shapiro elissa.h.shapiro@gmail.com Part time rental	Half Round (301) 503-6171 (301) 503-5663
P-7	Brandon Lindblad b.lindblad@gmail.com Kelsey Lindblad klindblad257@gmail.com Full time	Asgard (571) 437-6912 (757) 593-0667

Welcome to Coolfont!

You may have noticed many new faces in the community. Sales of homes are up this year!



From the Archives

The Des Moines Register, Des Moines, Iowa

9 Sep 1923, Sun • Page 392

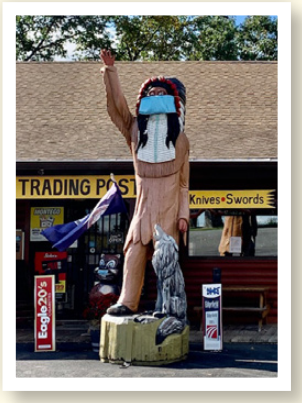


Where "Hawkeye" Was Written

This is "Coolfont," Herbert Quick's home in Berkeley Springs, W. Va., where "The Hawkeye" was written. At the right, Mr. Quick.



Holly Berry - Craig Deane (T-3)



Stay safe out there!

Sausage and Cabbage

Recipe Recommended by Cathy Levey (A-6)

by Julia Moskin, NYT Cooking, March 2020
Yield: 6 Servings, Time: 3 hours



This recipe is an adaptation of one created by Tamasin Day-Lewis, the Stevie Nicks of British cookery. A casserole recipe that she credits to the British food writer Jane Grigson has just four ingredients - sausage, cabbage, butter and pepper - but after two and a half hours in the oven, it emerges mysterious and succulent.

- Salt
- 3 tablespoons unsalted butter
- 2 pounds fresh sweet Italian pork sausages or bulk sausage
- 1 large green or Savoy cabbage, about 4 pounds, cored and thickly shredded
- Freshly ground black pepper
- Crusty bread and mustard, for serving

Heat oven to 300 degrees. Bring a large pot of salted water to a boil and butter a 9 x 13 x 2 inch baking dish. If using sausages, remove casings and discard them.

Place cabbage in boiling water, cover, and let water come back to the boil. Uncover and boil for 3 minutes. Drain cabbage in a colander and run cold water over it to stop cooking.

Put about 1/3 of the cabbage in buttered dish and cover with 1/2 the meat. Sprinkle with salt and pepper and dot with butter. Repeat, ending with a final layer of cabbage, and dot top with butter.

Cover dish tightly with a layer of parchment paper, then top with a lid or a layer of aluminum foil. Cook for about 2 1/2 hours, until cabbage is soft and sweet, and top is lightly browned. After 2 hours, uncover the dish: if there is a lot of liquid in the bottom, leave uncovered for the rest of the cooking time. If not, cover and finish cooking.

Rules & Regulations: Exterior Fire Policy

In October, the Board approved Resolution 2020-04 Exterior Fire Policy. Here are some excerpts from this Policy. **Residents are encouraged to review the entire text of the Policy**, available at www.coolfontmountainside.org in the Owners/Documents section.

- Each owner is responsible for control of exterior fires on their property....
- Open, on-, or in-ground fires are not allowed.
- Burning of trash or solid materials other than wood, coal, or charcoal is not permitted.
- Accelerants such as gasoline or petrochemicals, other than those specifically made for lighting charcoal, will not be used.
- All exterior fires must be attended by an adult knowledgeable of the container's operation and capable of extinguishing the fire whenever fire or coals are present.
- Any user ... of an exterior barbecue or fire container must have an AB or ABC rated fire extinguisher or a functional water hose capable of reaching the fire container and surrounding area ....
- Authorized fire containers:
  - Exterior gas fire containers that are UL certified, approved by the DACC or Board, and in good condition are permitted.
  - Wood burning exterior fire containers approved by the DACC or Board are permitted as long as they are purpose intended manufactured units of sturdy metal or non-combustible design ... with a metal cover made for and fit to the receptacle to prevent flying sparks and embers. Openings and covers must have no greater than ¼" mesh or equivalent openings.
  - Charcoal barbecues commercially built for the purpose may be used for cooking food, providing use of accelerants is minimized....
  - No fire container may have flames extending significantly beyond the receptacle, its cover, or chimney.
- Any violation of these rules, whether by an owner, member, family member, guest, or tenant may result in immediate Site Manager, DACC, or Board suspension or termination of previous approvals of fire containers and fines imposed by the Board to the owner.
- Owners, members, or visitors who observe Fire Prevention and Control violations should try to contact and inform the violator of these policies. They should also inform the owner, if not present, and CMA Site Manager, noting the date, time, owner's name, and lot number, if known.
- The Site Manager, or other CMA authority in the absence of the Site Manager, will make official notification to the owner of their responsibility to remedy the situation as well as to the Treasurer for fine imposition.
- Owners will take immediate action to correct a violation.
- Owners with repeat violations ... will be subject to a $50 fine per violation .... Subsequent violations subject the owner to a $100 fine per additional violation ....



W&S Tariff Review

by Dawne Holz, CMA Treasurer

In August 2020, CMA called upon volunteers to assist with a review of the current water and sewer rates for the community. These rates are determined by the WV Public Service Commission (PSC). After a thorough review of the utility's income and operating expenses, the PSC issues tariffs outlining the rates the utility can charge for services. CMA's rates have not been updated since December 2010 and no longer provide adequate income for the utility to meet its operating expenses.

Processing the Paperwork

In September, Coolfont Mountainside Association Water & Sewer (CMAWS) filed Tariff Form No. 11, Application to Change Rates, with the PSC. In October, we received PSC approval of our application for rate changes. They assigned a case number and staff analyst and requested a myriad of financial, usage, and other documents for review.

CMAWS provided a cover letter with the application requesting that the PSC work in tandem with CMAWS to determine new rates that are appropriate for the utility, fair to our customers, and consider our unique customer base and circumstances. The PSC confirmed they will work with CMAWS before submitting the proposed tariffs to the Commission for approval.

What's Next

The Committee anticipates it will be several months before the PSC completes its review and issues draft tariffs. Final tariffs will follow CMA Board review and approval from the PSC. We anticipate that the process will not be completed and finalized until 2021.

Tariff Review Committee

The committee meets virtually every two weeks to keep this project on track. If you have questions, please contact a committee member.

- Dawne Holz, Treasurer
- Cathy Levey, Chair, W/S
- Eric Lienhard, Board liaison
- Jackson Bain
- Bob Cohen
- Tom Holz
- Eileen Neely
- Joe Van Meter



Spectacular patch of knotweed - Craig Deane (T-3)

Board Shorts

August 8 Board Meeting (via Teleconference)

- Approved minutes from March 2020 CMA and W&S Meetings
- Approved Google Group Usage Guidelines
- Approved funding for Mailbox Expansion
- Approved Independent Contractor Agreement template and Purchasing and Contracting Guidance
- Approved change of office phone from Frontier to Verizon
- Ratified approved motion for AHPM to provide Certified Pool Operator for 2020 pool season
- Approved 2021 Proposed Budget, forward to membership for vote at Annual Meeting
- Approved final report from Decker & Company for 2019 financial records review
- Approved reinvestment of matured CD into two new CD's at CNB

September Annual Membership Meeting (Barn and via Teleconference)

- Approved minutes of September 2019 meeting
- Approved 2021 Budget
- Approved changes to Articles of Incorporation
- Elected three Board members

October 10 Board Meeting (via Teleconference)

- Elected Susan Betts as Board Secretary
- Approved minutes of August 2020 CMA and W&S Meetings
- Approved agreement with BTM CPAs for 2021 Bookkeeping services for CMA and CMAWS
- Approved additional funding for Barn Renovations
- Approved funding for replacement of road signs and posts
- Approved reserve investment in 12-month CD
- Approved termination of agreement with collections attorney

WOHOA
WEST VIRGINIA ORGANIZATION OF HOMEOWNERS ASSOCIATIONS
2020 MEMBER



This beauty dropped in on the Zuckermans for a quick visit. - Joanie Zuckerman (T-6)



Forest Floor Fungus - Eunice Pryor (G-3)

Coolfont Mountainside Association

P.O. Box 418, Berkeley Springs, WV 25411

Board of Directors

Jason Géno, President
Steve Katz, Vice President
Susan Betts, Secretary
Dawne Holz, Treasurer
Sharon Géno, Director
Eric Lienhard, Director
Cindy Van Meter, Director

Website

www.coolfontmountainside.org
User ID: owner Password: coolfont

Listserv Email

cma-members@googlegroups.com

Listserv Signup/Web

groups.google.com/forum/#!forum/cma-members

Facebook

www.facebook.com/groups/257606361406



COMMITTEES & CONTACTS

Our committees are staffed by volunteers. They welcome any assistance with projects and events. If you would like to help, please contact the committee chair.

Site Managers - Holly Malcomb & Jason Schetrompf
304-671-0882 cmasitemanager@gmail.com
304-676-3993

Communications - Dawne Holz
Facebook - Dawne Holz
Google Group - Cindy Van Meter
703-532-6862 cndyvm@yahoo.com
Newsletter - Dawne Holz
703-362-6727 coolfont.news@gmail.com
Website - Jeff Stovall
850-339-5279 jefferson.stovall@gmail.com

DACC - Dennis Daisey
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Finance - Dawne Holz
703-362-6727 dawneholz@gmail.com

Firewise - Heidi Splane
610-742-5774 heidianderic@comcast.net

Infrastructure Mapping - Tom Holz
703-627-9391 tlholz@me.com

Neighborhood Watch - Cathy Levey
304-258-5481 mccm2012@hotmail.com

Nominations/Elections - Rusty McCrady
240-723-5930 rusty.mccrady@gmail.com

Social - Holly Malcomb & Kathy Katz
304-671-0882 cmasitemanager@gmail.com
304-258-9329 kathyk717@aol.com

Welcome - Rosemary Bigelow
304-258-5352 rosemary@mygrandmotherslace.com

Water & Sewer

Chair - Cathy Levey
304-258-5481 mccm2012@hotmail.com

Warm Springs Public Svc Dist
Mon - Fri, 9:00 am - 5:00 pm: 304-258-4118
All other times: Morgan County 304-258-0305

Join the CMA Facebook group!
Search Coolfont Mountainside Association in Facebook groups!